

Lesson 5: SankofaPOWER – Choropleths

Lab Instructions

In this lab we will begin to conduct a [demographic](#) study of Minneapolis using the most recent American Community Survey ([ACS](#)) data.

Download the QGIS Project

- 1) Go to _____ to download a QGIS template for this assignment.
 - a) Download
 - b) Unzip
 - c) Open
 - i) If no data on screen, right click data layer and **Zoom to Layer (s)**
-

Explore the Map View

- 1) The top two layers on the map are cartographic. The third layer, Demo_Data, contains various variables calculated from American Community Survey 2019-2023 five-year estimates. The bottom layer is a basemap created by CartoDB.
- 2) Right click on the layer titled, **Demo_Data**. Select **Properties** then navigate to the **Symbology** panel 

- a) The **Value** parameter will tell us which variable is being plotted on the choropleth.

Please **change Value** to any other variable you're interested in.

- b) The **Color Ramp** is where we describe to the computer which colors to paint. Notice that this color ramp is [Sequential](#), [Colorblind](#) accessible, and slightly transparent (low opacity)
 - c) Under **Classes**, we define how to “[chop up](#)” the data. Feel free to experiment with the algorithm (mode) for classification, number of classes, you can even manually create your own intervals!
 - d) Click **Apply** to see changes appear in the Map View. When Satisfied, click **OK**

3) Navigate around the map and make some observations. You can use the Identify Features button to click on areas and see specific values.



Do you see:

Anything surprising?

Any patterns?

Relationships between your choropleth and the maps from session 1?

Explore the Layout



1) Go to the layout manager and double click on the pre-made layout, **ForPrint**

2) This map is almost there! It has the essential elements - Title, North Arrow, Legend, Data Sources, Scale Bar, Author but could use a little personalization.

Specifically, we will need to change the Title, Legend, and Author Name

Single click on any item on the sheet of paper, then right click and select **Item Properties** to alter the items.

3) When you're satisfied, export this map to PDF and save it somewhere safe!
